

Representing inputs as vectors

Project: Image-pattern Network Investigation

1. Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Encode a record using a fixed feature order and units

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

ML Builder Expo

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from ML Builder Expo. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Defend the project using traceable evidence

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Teacher explanation: A valid response names the fictional task, reports an auditable baseline/candidate comparison with denominator, and restricts the claim to the evaluated setup.

Begin Grade 9 by connecting the Grade 8 feature table to an ordered numerical input. Students should name every component before calculating. Use two 45-minute sessions. Avoid treating a vector as a mysterious neural object: the learning target is a precise data contract, including order, units, missing values and the distinction between inputs and targets.

Outcomes

Encode a record using a fixed feature order and units

Distinguish a vector dimension from the number of examples

Detect missing values and target leakage before computation

Preparation

Printed lesson and workbook; paper and pencil

Calculator and optional local Python 3 editor; no packages or AI accounts needed

Use the fictional examples supplied; prepare the fresh retry before class

Prerequisite answer

The class is the target being predicted. Supplying that answer as an input leaks information that would not be available for a new prediction.

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can explain representing inputs as vectors using a traced example and a stated limitation.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain and model the mechanism

A neural network receives numbers in a specified order. Before learning how it computes, we need to represent one example without losing the meaning of its fields. A vector is an ordered list: [4, 2] can mean

width 4 cm and height 2 cm if that is the declared order. Reversing the two numbers describes a different rectangle under the same schema.

For this fictional parcel investigation, use [width in cm, height in cm]. Width and height must both be present and greater than zero. The vector has dimension 2 because it contains two components. Record IDs identify examples; they do not measure the parcel. The target class is stored separately.

There are three examples, each with two features. Stacking their vectors makes a table with three rows and two columns. Do not confuse the number of rows with the dimension of one input.

Read fields by name, convert to the declared units, validate, and only then write the vector. Parcel D has width 50 mm and height 30 mm. Because 10 mm equals 1 cm, its encoded vector is [5, 3]. Writing [50, 30] would preserve the numbers while changing the physical meaning by a factor of ten.

This short function assumes each supplied value is a number in mm or None for missing. It is a classroom example, not a complete input validator. Trace the conversion before running it. The function represents data; it does not fit a model or predict a class.

Term · Meaning

Term: Vector

Meaning: An ordered list of numerical components

Term: Component

Meaning: One value at a specified position in a vector

Term: Dimension

Meaning: The number of components in a vector

Term: Schema

Meaning: The recorded feature order, units and validity rules

An input vector keeps an agreed order

Source record · Encoding action · Model input

Source record: D width 50 mm

Encoding action: Divide width by 10

Model input: First component 5

Source record: D height 30 mm

Encoding action: Divide height by 10

Model input: Second component 3

Source record: Schema width then height

Encoding action: Keep named positions

Model input: Vector [5, 3] in cm

Read each row left to right, then assemble the final ordered pair. The schema explains the numbers; the vector alone does not.

Guided E: [2, 7]. The reversed [7, 2] means width 7 cm and height 2 cm, a different measurement pair.

Exit: [4, 2] reveals only width and height under the schema. It cannot reveal the omitted distinction causing different labels; the same deterministic input receives the same output.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

An input vector keeps an agreed order

Source record · Encoding action · Model input

Source record: D width 50 mm

Encoding action: Divide width by 10

Model input: First component 5

Source record: D height 30 mm

Encoding action: Divide height by 10

Model input: Second component 3

Source record: Schema width then height

Encoding action: Keep named positions

Model input: Vector [5, 3] in cm

Read each row left to right, then assemble the final ordered pair. The schema explains the numbers; the vector alone does not.

Parcel E has width 20 mm and height 70 mm. Encode it and explain why [7, 2] is not the same input under this schema.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Representing inputs as vectors

Encode the same pixel measurements in a fixed vector order.

The facts we will use

Toy image features are [left_brightness, right_brightness], each = 0..10. ImageA has left2, right7; imageB has left7, right2.

AI ACADEMY / AI-5/1

Representing inputs as vectors

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Declare coordinate order

Coordinate0 is left brightness; coordinate1 is right brightness.



2. Encode both images

A becomes [2, 7]; B becomes [7, 2]. Their sums match but their spatial patterns differ.



3. Check input contract

Use the same order when training and predicting; record missing measurements rather than guessing.

CHANGE ONE THING

Swap only A's vector order before prediction.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Declare coordinate order

What happens and why: Coordinate0 is left brightness; coordinate1 is right brightness.

Step: 2. Encode both images

What happens and why: A becomes [2, 7]; B becomes [7, 2]. Their sums match but their spatial patterns

differ.

Step: 3. Check input contract

What happens and why: Use the same order when training and predicting; record missing measurements rather than guessing.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

A vector is an ordered list, so the position of a number carries meaning. Here the first number always means left brightness. Adding the two measurements keeps total brightness but discards which side is brighter. A network receives the representation we give it; it cannot recover a lost distinction just because it has more layers.

What this example does not establish

These two features are simplified measurements, not a complete image representation or evidence of learned vision.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Swap only A's vector order before prediction.

Prediction: The encoded input becomes [7, 2], numerically identical to B's original input.

Reason: Changing coordinate order changes feature meaning even if the numbers are unchanged.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Time or stage · Teacher action

Time or stage: Session 1 start to 7 minutes

Teacher action: Ask the prerequisite question. Retrieve the distinction between a feature and a target; require a prediction-time explanation.

Time or stage: 7 to 18 minutes

Teacher action: Place A, B and C on paper. Students label horizontal width and vertical height, then write vectors with the schema above them.

Time or stage: 18 to 32 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W1 and W2. Contrast three examples with two components per example. Model the mm-to-cm conversion explicitly.

Time or stage: 32 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Trace the Python function or its paper equivalent. Complete the guided E case and compare the swapped vector.

Time or stage: Session 2 start to 8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the schema without looking. Ask how two correctly sized vectors can have different meanings.

Time or stage: 8 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Use W3 and the identical-input example. Discuss valid zero in another schema without changing the parcel rule.

Time or stage: 20 to 35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently before giving hints. Check field order, dimensions, valid age zero and the excluded future target.

Time or stage: 35 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Use W5 and the exit response. Give targeted feedback, then administer the fresh retry and retain both attempts.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a prediction before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Provide empty boxes labelled with feature names and units. Accept a correct spoken explanation before written notation. Extension: propose two different real objects that share the same two-feature vector, then identify an additional measurable feature available before prediction.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: A new record has width 60 mm and height 10 mm. Give its vector in the agreed cm schema, and name one error in [60, 10].

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: The vector is [6, 1]. [60, 10] uses mm numbers where cm numbers are expected, scaling both measurements tenfold.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Representing inputs as vectors. Proposed explanation: "Order does not matter". Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: A and B use the same numbers but assign them to different features. Read each position by name.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Why does equal total brightness not make A and B identical inputs? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

Reasoned teacher answer

A and B place brightness in different positions. The ordered vectors distinguish left/right structure; their common sum 9 loses that distinction. Changed-case check: The encoded input becomes [7, 2], numerically identical to B's original input. Changing coordinate order changes feature meaning even if the numbers are unchanged.

Changed-case reasoning: The encoded input becomes [7, 2], numerically identical to B's original input. Changing coordinate order changes feature meaning even if the numbers are unchanged.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

Order does not matter: A and B use the same numbers but assign them to different features. Read each position by name.

More rows increase vector dimension: Rows count examples; components count features of one example.

A missing value is zero: Whether zero is valid depends on the field. Missing means unknown, and is not interchangeable with a measured zero.

Use Section 9 for the evidence ledger. Add a boundary or missing-input case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Guided and exit questions

Guided E: [2, 7]. The reversed [7, 2] means width 7 cm and height 2 cm, a different measurement pair.

Exit: [4, 2] reveals only width and height under the schema. It cannot reveal the omitted distinction causing different labels; the same deterministic input receives the same output.

W1 Encode the records

Write A, B and C as ordered pairs from the lesson. State the dimension of each and the shape of the stacked table.

Teacher explanation: A [4, 2], B [2, 4], C [3, 3]. Each has dimension 2. The table has 3 rows and 2 columns.

W2 Convert before encoding

A new record has width 60 mm and height 10 mm. Give its vector in the agreed cm schema, and name one error in [60, 10].

Teacher explanation: The vector is [6, 1]. [60, 10] uses mm numbers where cm numbers are expected, scaling both measurements tenfold.

W3 Handle missing information

Width is 4 cm and height is missing. A teammate writes [4, 0]. Explain why this is invalid and give the action required by this schema.

Teacher explanation: Missing is not measured zero. Height must be present and positive; reject the record and request a valid measurement before encoding.

W4 Apply a new schema independently

A new toy battery task uses [temperature in degrees C, voltage in V, age in days]. Record K has voltage 5, age 12, temperature 18. Record L has temperature 20, voltage 4, age 0. Encode both; state the vector dimension and table shape. Age zero is valid. The future failure label is also supplied in the data file: should it be appended?

Teacher explanation: K [18, 5, 12], L [20, 4, 0]. Dimension 3, table 2 rows by 3 columns. Age zero is a valid known value. Exclude the future failure target from inputs; it is not available at prediction time.

W5 Explain a collision

Two parcels have the same width and height but different material and target class. Explain why adding more examples alone cannot let this deterministic two-feature model tell these two inputs apart.

Teacher explanation: The two input vectors are identical, so the fixed deterministic computation returns the same output. Additional rows do not create a missing distinction in these two vectors; a relevant available feature or an explicit uncertainty policy may be needed.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

Assess W4 for named order, all values retained, dimension 3, two-row shape and exclusion of the future label. Fresh retry: schema [mass in g, length in cm]; two records (length 4, mass 12) and (mass 9, length 6) encode as [12, 4] and [9, 6], dimension 2, table 2 by 2. Ask why an absent mass must not become zero without a declared policy.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: A new toy battery task uses [temperature in degrees C, voltage in V, age in days]. Record K has voltage 5, age 12, temperature 18. Record L has temperature 20, voltage 4, age 0. Encode both; state the vector dimension and table shape. Age zero is valid. The future failure label is also supplied in the data file: should it be appended?

Selected case answer

Teacher explanation: K [18, 5, 12], L [20, 4, 0]. Dimension 3, table 2 rows by 3 columns. Age zero is a valid known value. Exclude the future failure target from inputs; it is not available at prediction time.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect the project, support and next lesson

Add a labelled representing inputs as vectors evidence sheet to Image-pattern Network Investigation. Show how you can encode a record using a fixed feature order and units. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Provide empty boxes labelled with feature names and units. Accept a correct spoken explanation before written notation. Extension: propose two different real objects that share the same two-feature vector, then identify an additional measurable feature available before prediction.

Week 2 uses the ordered components in dot products. Revisit order and signed multiplication before introducing weights.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-5/2, ai-5/4, ai-5/7. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For your Image-pattern Network Investigation, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.